GFH1000: In Dialogue with Humanity

Guidelines on Reflective Journal

Deng Yangzhou

A: Introduction

Below are some points to bear in mind when writing a reflective journal.

1) At the top of the page, state: (1) the course code and course title, (2) your name and student number, (3) the date, and the number of the question you are addressing. Adopt the following format: Times New Roman/宋體, or 新明細體; font size 12; 1.5 line spacing. (See below [p.2] for a sample.)

2) Try always to read *closely* (i.e., attentively and in detail) and analyze passages in the selected classic text that are relevant to the question you address.

3) A long and detailed introduction may be a good practice when writing a long term paper, but not advisable for a reflective journal, which has a much lower word limit. One or two short sentences as introduction are usually enough.

4) Support your points by referring to the relevant passages. For example, you may want to make a point that Athena’s dialogue with Telemachus is very important to the young man. You should show that your point is valid by referring to the text. Which line or phrase, from which book or books, suggests your point? You may paraphrase it (i.e., express the meaning in your own words), or make a direct quotation, such as: “Athena put courage in Telemachus’ heart” (1:338). If the relevant passage is long, do not quote it in full. Either quote the most representative line(s), or summarize it.

5) Always remember to give the source (i.e., the location) of each passage that you quote, paraphrase or summarize in presenting the writer’s view or in support of your argument. For the *Odyssey*, you state the source by giving the book and line number, e.g., 1:338, 1:121-125 or 1:220 f. (i.e., line 220 and the following ones in Book 1.).

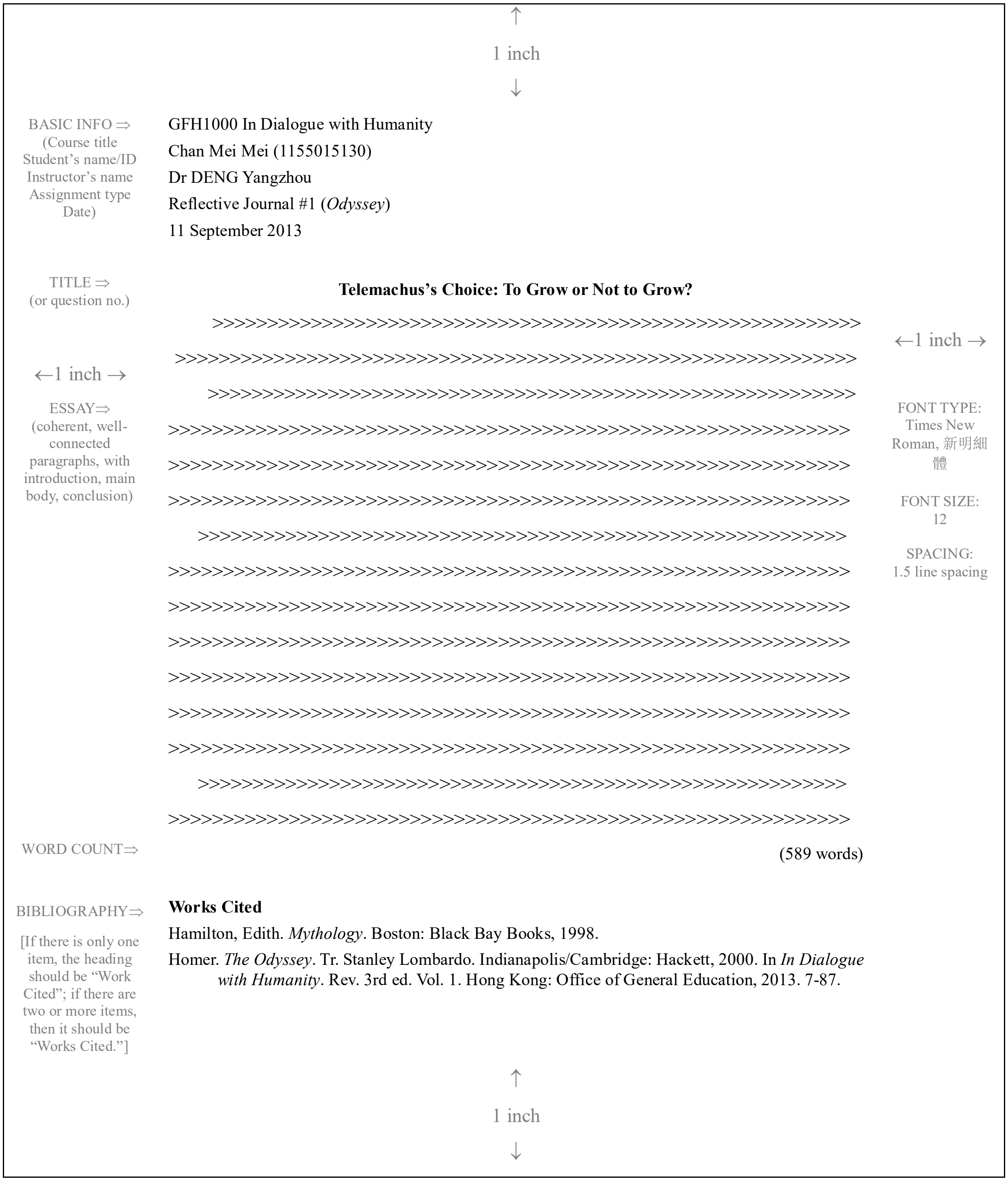
6) You may use sources other than the course book to clarify or support your points. This may be rare for reflective journals due to the word limit, but in case you do, please, again, remember to name the source. **Using or quoting other people’s works or ideas is a general practice in academic writing; but quoting and using them without naming the source is an act of plagiarism**. Let us learn to be responsible for our own work and respect others’.

7) Do not number your points by using I, II, etc. (or 1, 2, 3, etc.). This is a common practice for papers of the humanities. Sometimes we see numberings when the papers are very long. The numbering usually helps divide the long paper into smaller sections. For our purpose here – a short reflective journal – try to connect your points with words such as “first,” “second,” etc., or with conjunctions (“and,” “or,” “but,” “nor,” “so,” “yet,” “for”) or connectives (“In addition,, “Moreover,” etc.).

8) You can write in Chinese or English, but do not use mixed languages, e.g.「正如雅典娜（Athena）所說，奧德修斯 “understands the correct order of things”。」If you write in Chinese, it is good practice – though not necessary – that you give the English transliteration of the proper names (such as those of characters, places etc.). But you should translate the passages you quote into Chinese if that’s your chosen language for the journal. In the same way, if you decide to write in English for the texts that we read in Chinese, you would have to translate the quotations into English. You can of course make use of existing English translations from

the library. Again, remember to include the name of the translator in your reference.

B: Standard Layout (A4 sheet)



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1 inch
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BASIC INFO ⇒
(Course title
Student's name/ID
Instructor's name
Assignment type
Date)

GFH1000 In Dialogue with Humanity
Chan Mei Mei (1155015130)
Dr DENG Yangzhou
Reflective Journal #1 (*Odyssey*)
11 September 2013

TITLE ⇒
(or question no.)

Telemachus's Choice: To Grow or Not to Grow?

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ESSAY⇒
(coherent, well-connected paragraphs, with introduction, main body, conclusion)

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FONT TYPE:
Times New Roman, 新明細體

FONT SIZE:
12

SPACING:
1.5 line spacing

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WORD COUNT⇒

(589 words)

BIBLIOGRAPHY⇒

[If there is only one item, the heading should be "Work Cited"; if there are two or more items, then it should be "Works Cited."]

Works Cited

Hamilton, Edith. *Mythology*. Boston: Black Bay Books, 1998.

Homer. *The Odyssey*. Tr. Stanley Lombardo. Indianapolis/Cambridge: Hackett, 2000. In *In Dialogue with Humanity*. Rev. 3rd ed. Vol. 1. Hong Kong: Office of General Education, 2013. 7-87.

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C: Question Pool

2: *Symposium*

Instructions:

1) Choose ONE of the following questions, and write a short response of about 500-700 words in English or 600-800 characters in Chinese.
2) State the book and line number when making a citation from the *Symposium*, e.g. "(210a-211c)".
3) Save your work with a name of "Student ID-RJ-2.doc" (replacing "Student ID" with your real ID), and submit it as an attachment via Blackboard before the first tutorial on *Symposium* (Mon 10:30). Late submission will be deemed as invalid.

Questions:

1) Examine Socrates' interrogation of Agathon (199 c-201c). What is the central problem that Socrates wants to clarify, and how does he make Agathon convinced?
2) Examine Diotima's speech, and compare it with any one of the speeches from Pausanias, Agathon, and Alcibiades. In what ways is Diotima's similar and different from the other one?
3) How does Alcibiades contribute to the main theme of the whole dialogue?

3: *Nicomachean Ethics*

Instructions:

1) Choose ONE of the following questions, and write a short response of about 500-700 words in English or 600-800 characters in Chinese.
2) State the book and line number when making a citation from the *Nicomachean Ethics*, e.g. "(1094a15-20)").
3) Save your work with a name of "Student ID-RJ-3.doc" (replacing "Student ID" with your real ID), and submit it as an attachment via Blackboard before the first tutorial on *Nicomachean Ethics* (Mon 10:30). Late submission will be deemed as invalid.

Questions:

1. In "Book I" of the *Nicomachean Ethics*, Aristotle uses the "functional argument" to determine happiness (*eudaimonia*) as the final good in the life of human beings (1097a23-1098a21). Can you reconstruct his argument?
2. Aristotle thinks that goodness is the sole essence of friendship. Do you agree? Would it be possible to be a permanent friend with a person whose character is not good enough?

4: *Analects*

Instructions:

1) Choose ONE of the following questions, and write a short response of about 500-700 words in English or 600-800 characters in Chinese.
2) State the book and line number when making a citation from the *Analects*, e.g. “(7.38)”.
3) Save your work with a name of “Student ID-RJ-4.doc” (replacing “Student ID” with your real ID), and submit it as an attachment via Blackboard before the first tutorial on *Analects* (Mon 10:30).. Late submission will be deemed as invalid.
4) For full text of the *Analects*, visit ctext.org

Questions:

1. Read the story from the *Analects* (17:21) between the debate of Zai Wo and Confucius on the importance of the ritual of “three years' mourning” (The Analects : Yang Huo - Chinese Text Project (ctext.org)). Whose stance would you agree with? Write an argument for your position.

2. Read the story in 13:18 (The Analects : Zi Lu - Chinese Text Project (ctext.org)) on Confucius’ idea of treatment of a guilty father. Do you agree with him? Justify your position with an argument.

5: *Zhuangzi*

Instructions:

1) Choose ONE of the following questions, and write a short response of about 500-700 words in English or 600-800 characters in Chinese.
2) State the book and line number when making a citation from the *Zhuangzi*, e.g. “<逍遙遊>”.
3) Save your work with a name of “Student ID-RJ-5.doc” (replacing “Student ID” with your real ID), and submit it as an attachment via Blackboard before the first tutorial on *Zhuangzi* (Mon 10:30).. Late submission will be deemed as invalid.

Questions:

1. For Zhuangzi, “predetermined mind” (成心) is a negative element that impedes free fulfillment of the natural potentials of humans and things. He raises a host of examples in the texts of predetermined minds, such as *Yao* (尧), the *Song* man (宋人), *Huishi* (惠子), etc.. Study two or three of these examples in the context, and explain how they are enslaved by some predetermined minds, and what the result of the spiritual slavery is.
2. In which context Zhuangzi comments on the Confucian idea of *Ren* (仁，Humanness, Benevolence)? What is his attitude toward it, and how does he articulate his attitude?
3.Find the story of Zhuang’s dream of transforming himself into a butterfly, study the context, think about its relevance to the main point of the text of “Equality of Everything” (齊物論), and explain its meaning.